

Insurance Sales (General)

Standard Operating Procedure

Document Reference	SOP-INS-010
Version	1.3
Effective Date	01 February 2025
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Owner	Sales Operations
Approved By	Chief Sales Officer
Classification	Internal Use Only
Applicable To	All new client policy sales processed via agent or call centre channels across Meridian Insurance Group product lines

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the general process for signing up a new client for an insurance policy through Meridian Insurance Group's agent or call centre channel. It provides a channel-agnostic framework applicable across all product lines, establishing minimum conduct, documentation, and compliance standards that must be met regardless of product type.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to:

- All new insurance policy sales initiated by a licensed agent or call centre representative
- All personal and commercial product lines where a product-specific SOP does not supersede this procedure
- Telephone and face-to-face sales interactions

This procedure does NOT cover: digital direct sales without representative involvement (SOP-INS-001), group enrolments (SOP-INS-006), or policy renewals (addressed within SOP-INS-004).

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Customer Service Representative / Agent	Conducts needs analysis; presents product options; discloses product terms; completes application; confirms policyholder understanding; issues temporary cover note where applicable.
Member Care Representative	Provides second-level support for complex needs assessments; handles clients who require additional guidance; reviews applications flagged for suitability concerns.
Policy Service Representative	Processes completed applications in PAS; issues policy documents; updates CRM with policy details; handles premium setup in conjunction with Finance.
Team Leader / Sales Supervisor	Approves exceptions outside standard authority (e.g., backdated cover, substandard terms); conducts post-sale quality checks; manages daily sales reporting.

4. Pre-requisites and Triggers

Triggered by an inbound or outbound contact with a prospective new client, or a referral from an existing policyholder or agent. The representative must be licensed and appointed for the product line being sold before initiating any sales interaction.

5. Process Steps

5.1 Needs Analysis and Suitability Assessment

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
1	Client contact initiated (inbound or outbound)	Agent / CSR	Contact logged in CRM; prospect record created; channel and source code recorded

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
2	Needs analysis conducted	Agent / CSR	Client's insurance needs, financial situation, existing coverage, and risk profile assessed using the Meridian Needs Analysis Framework
3	Product suitability confirmed	Agent / CSR	Suitable product(s) identified; if no suitable product exists, client referred appropriately; suitability decision documented in CRM
4	Product Disclosure Statement (PDS) provided	Agent / CSR	PDS for recommended product provided to client; receipt confirmed by client (verbal on call, digital acknowledgement on portal)

5.2 Application Completion

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
5	Application details collected	Agent / CSR	All required fields completed; material information confirmed with client and recorded verbatim in CRM notes
6	Application submitted in PAS / agent portal	Agent / CSR	Application ID generated; auto-accept or referral decision triggered
7	Underwriting referral handled (if applicable)	Agent / Underwriting	Client advised of referral; SLA communicated; agent follows up with client within agreed timeframe
8	Terms and premium confirmed with client	Agent / CSR	Final premium, payment options, start date, and coverage summary repeated back to client; confirmation obtained

5.3 Policy Issuance and Post-Sale

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
9	First premium payment collected	Agent / CSR / Payment Gateway	Payment processed; receipt provided to client; GIRO/direct debit mandate set up if instalment selected
10	Policy issued and documents dispatched	Policy Service Rep / PAS	Policy number confirmed; documents dispatched per SOP-INS-004 timelines

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
11	Post-sale quality check	Team Leader	10% of calls and digital interactions reviewed for conduct and suitability compliance; coaching provided as required
12	CRM updated with policy outcome	Agent / CSR	Policy number, product, premium, and payment arrangement recorded; annual review date set

6. Decision Points and Exception Handling

6.1 Client Declines Recommended Product

- Agent records the declination and the client's stated reason in CRM
- If the client proceeds with a different product against agent recommendation: suitability override form completed and signed by client
- All overrides reviewed by Team Leader within 24 hours

6.2 Suitability Concern Identified

- If the representative is uncertain whether a product is suitable, the interaction is paused and escalated to Member Care or a Team Leader
- No product is sold to a client where a material suitability doubt exists without second-level approval

6.3 Client Vulnerable or in Financial Difficulty

- Meridian vulnerable customer protocols apply; representative does not proceed with sale if vulnerability is apparent and the product may not be in the client's best interest
- Client referred to financial counselling or government assistance resources where appropriate

7. Systems and Tools

System / Tool	Purpose	Access
CRM (Salesforce)	Contact and prospect management, needs analysis documentation, post-sale records	All roles
Policy Administration System (PAS)	Application processing, policy issuance, document generation	CSR, Policy Service Rep
Agent Portal (Meridian Connect)	Quotation, application, and payment handling for agent channel	Agent
Call Recording System (NICE)	Recording of phone interactions for compliance and quality review	Automated / Team Leader
Payment Gateway	Premium collection at point of sale	Agent, CSR

8. Key Performance Indicators

- New policy sales volume: Monthly target set by product and channel (refer Sales Performance Dashboard)

- Suitability compliance rate: 100% of sales records contain a completed needs analysis and suitability determination
- Post-sale quality score: Minimum 85% of reviewed interactions meet conduct standards
- PDS delivery compliance: 100% of clients receive PDS before application is completed
- Vulnerable customer protocol adherence: Zero upheld complaints relating to inappropriate sales to vulnerable clients

9. Related Documents

- SOP-INS-004: Prospect-to-Issue
- SOP-INS-008: Auto and Home Insurance Sales
- SOP-INS-009: In-Force Customer Service (General)
- POL-COMP-004: Product Disclosure and Sales Conduct Policy
- POL-COMP-006: Vulnerable Customer Policy

10. Document Control and Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	01 Apr 2022	P. Adeyemi, Sales Ops	Initial release
1.1	20 Dec 2022	P. Adeyemi, Sales Ops	Added suitability override form; updated post-sale QA steps
1.2	15 Jun 2024	M. Reyes, Compliance	Added vulnerable customer exception; aligned to revised conduct guidelines
1.3	01 Feb 2025	M. Reyes, Compliance	Updated PDS delivery requirements; aligned KPIs to Salesforce reporting